

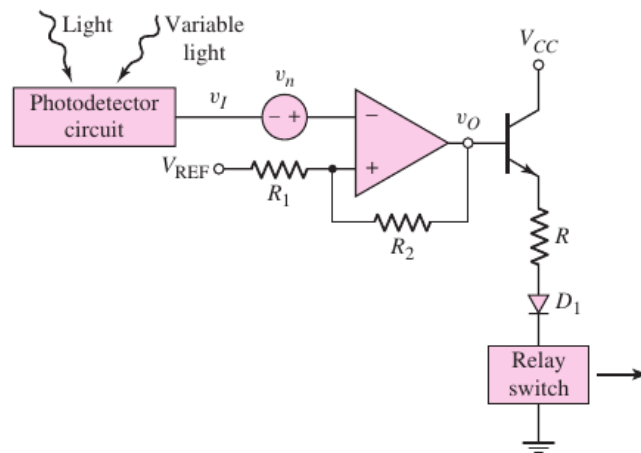
BRAC UNIVERSITY
Department of Computer Science & Engineering
Practice Problem Sheet - Schmitt Trigger
CSE 350: Digital Electronics and Pulse Technique

Question 1 - Street Light Control

Previously, we designed a street light control circuit using a simple op-amp comparator. But it damaged some of the street lights.

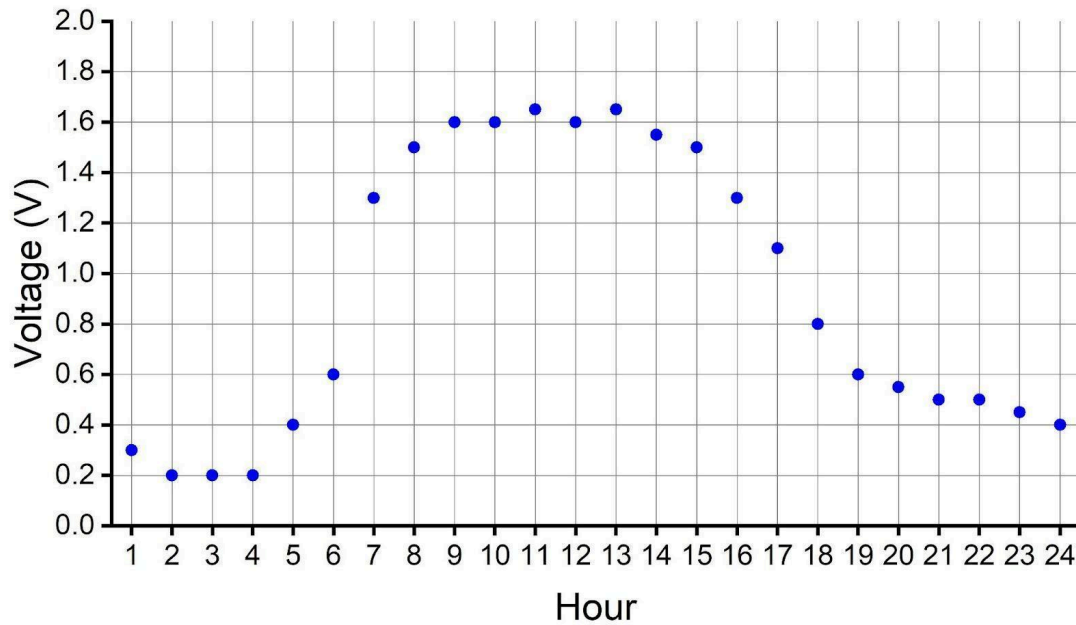
Now, we want to design a street light control circuit using Schmitt trigger, as shown below. This design employing Schmitt trigger circuit is robust to environmental noise and photodetector's shot-noise, so hopefully it will not damage the street lights this time.

We want to install our street light control system in Mohammadpur, Dhaka. So, we went there last week to collect photodetector circuit data. Our collected data over 24 hours is shown in the plot below. Note that, the output voltage of a photodetector circuit is directly proportional to the amount of light incident on it and we use this output voltage as an input voltage of the schmitt trigger circuit.



Now, help us in selecting the appropriate values of the circuit parameters.

(a)	Choose an appropriate value of the shifting voltage V_s .
(b)	We found that the combined noise voltage has a peak-to-peak voltage of around 0.1 V. Considering this, choose an appropriate value of the hysteresis width of the schmitt trigger circuit.
(c)	For your chosen shifting voltage and hysteresis width, select the values of R_1 , R_2 , V_{REF} .



Solution:

(a) Choose an appropriate value of the switching voltage V_s .

In the plot, we can see that photodetector's output voltage rises steeply between 6 am - 7 am. Also, the output voltage decreases sharply between 4 pm - 6 pm. So, these are the time windows when we have to turn on/off the street lights.

Now, observe the voltage values during these time windows.

'1 V' seems to be a right choice for switching voltage.

(b)	We found that the combined noise voltage has a peak-to-peak voltage of around 0.1 V. Considering this, choose an appropriate value of the hysteresis width of the schmitt trigger circuit.
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The main advantage of schmitt trigger over comparator circuit is the noise immunity. The hysteresis width actually determines how much immune the circuit is to noise voltage.

so choose, $\boxed{\text{Hysteresis width} = \text{peak to peak noise voltage} = 0.1 \text{ V}}$

(c)	For your chosen switching voltage and hysteresis width, select the values of R_1 , R_2 , V_{REF} .
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We need, $V_S = 1 \text{ V}$

$$\text{Hysteresis width} = 0.1 \text{ V}$$

Now, $\text{Hysteresis width} = V_{+H} - V_{+L} = \frac{R_1}{R_1 + R_2} (V_H - V_L) \dots \dots (1)$

Let's assume, $V_H = 5 \text{ V}$, $V_L = -5 \text{ V}$

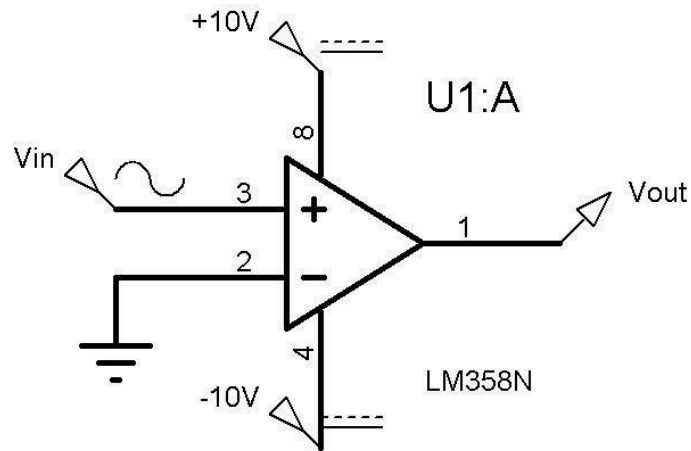
so, (1) $\Rightarrow \frac{R_2}{R_1} = 99$

Choose, $\boxed{R_1 = 1 \text{ K}; \text{ so } R_2 = 99 \text{ K}}$

and $V_S = \frac{R_2}{R_1 + R_2} V_{\text{REF}} = 1 \text{ V} \Rightarrow \boxed{V_{\text{REF}} = 1.01 \text{ V}}$

Question 2 - Comparator

For the OP-AMP comparator circuit below, V_{in} vs time plot is given. Draw the V_{out} vs time plot for the given input.



Solution:

For the OP-AMP comparator, we know that

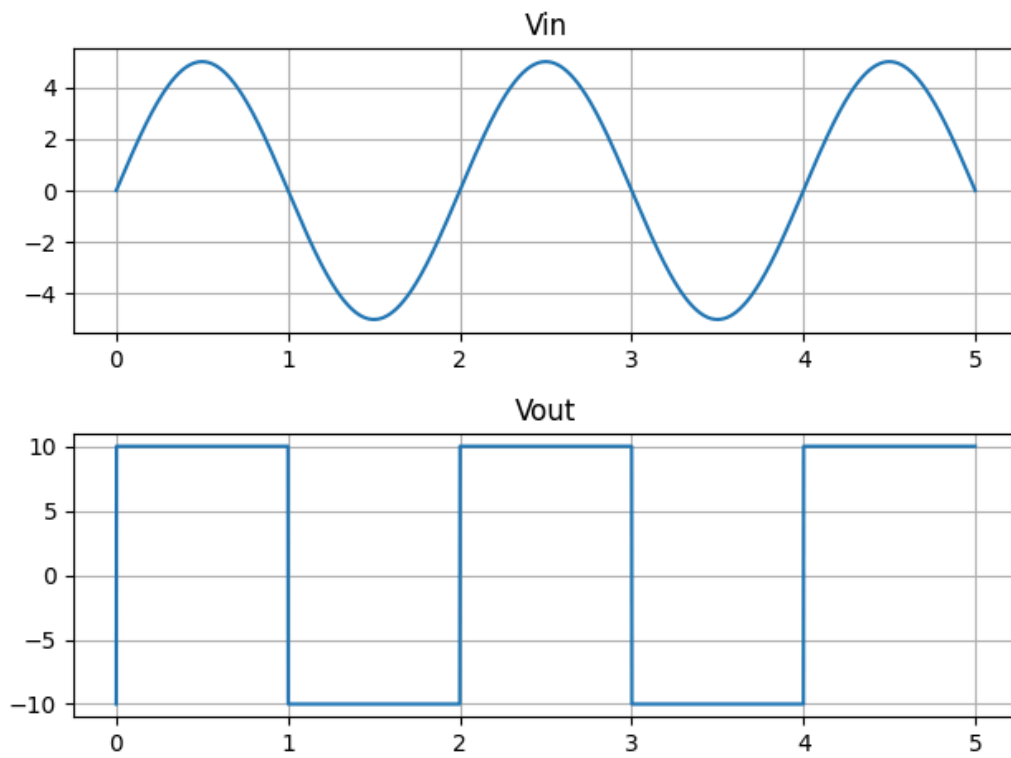
$$V_{out} = V_H \text{ if } V_+ > V_-$$

$$V_{out} = V_L \text{ if } V_+ < V_-$$

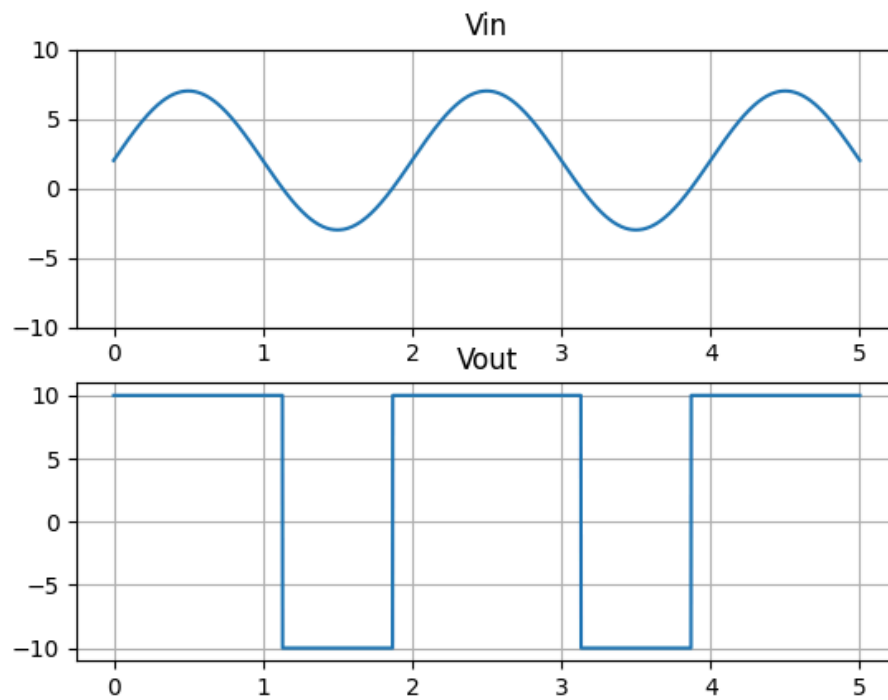
Since, V_- is connected to ground, we have,

$$V_{out} = +10V \text{ if } V_{in} > 0V$$

$$V_{out} = -10V \text{ if } V_{in} < 0V$$



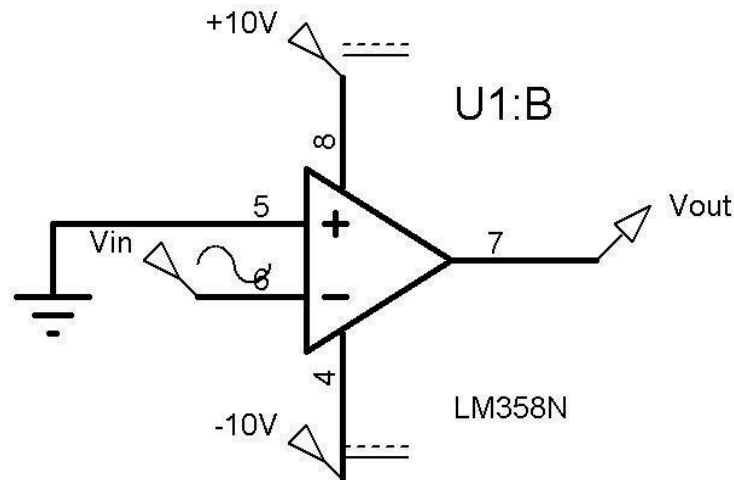
Output for input (a)



Output for input (b)

Question 3 - Comparator

For the OP-AMP comparator circuit below, V_{in} vs time plot is given. Draw the V_{out} vs time plot for the given input.



Solution:

For the OP-AMP comparator, we know that

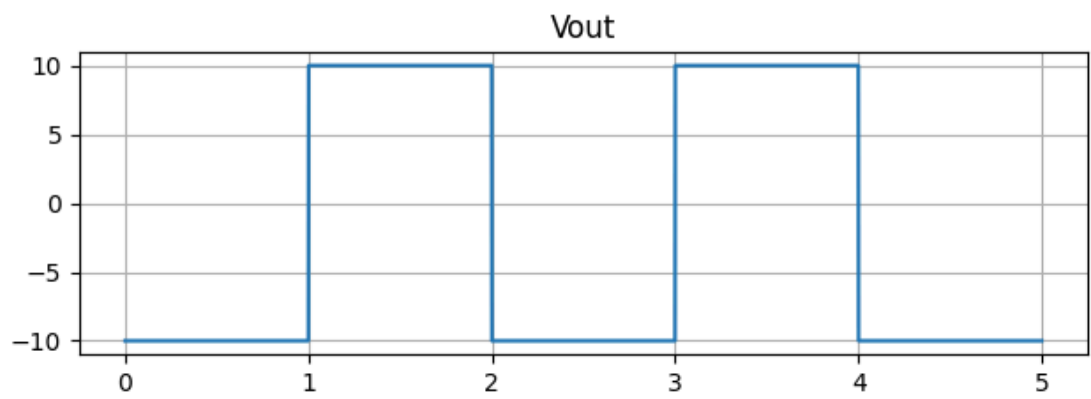
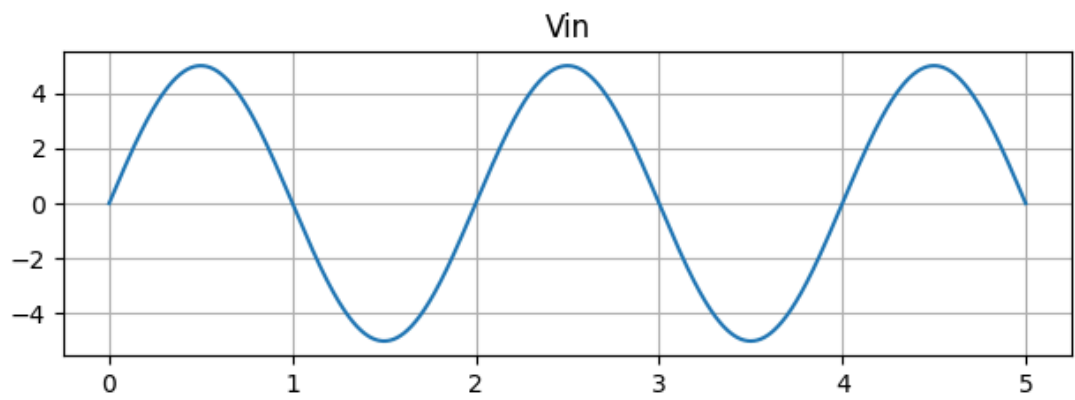
$$V_{out} = V_H \text{ if } V_+ > V_-$$

$$V_{out} = V_L \text{ if } V_+ < V_-$$

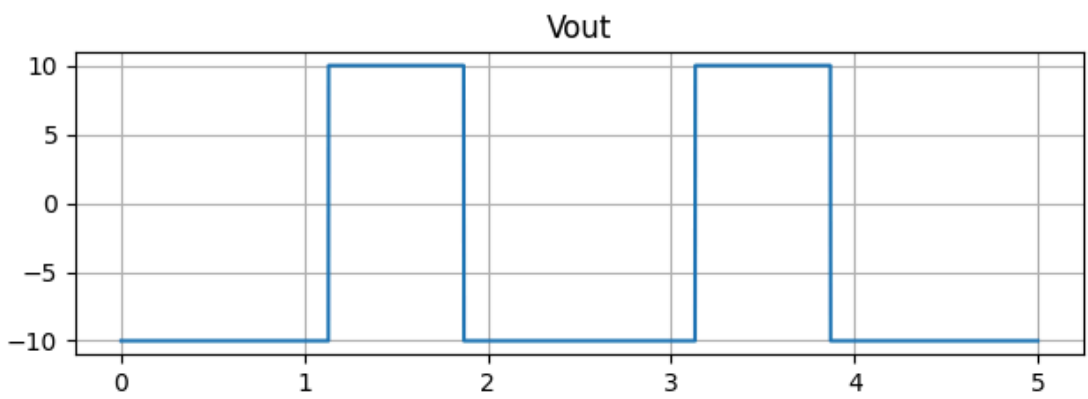
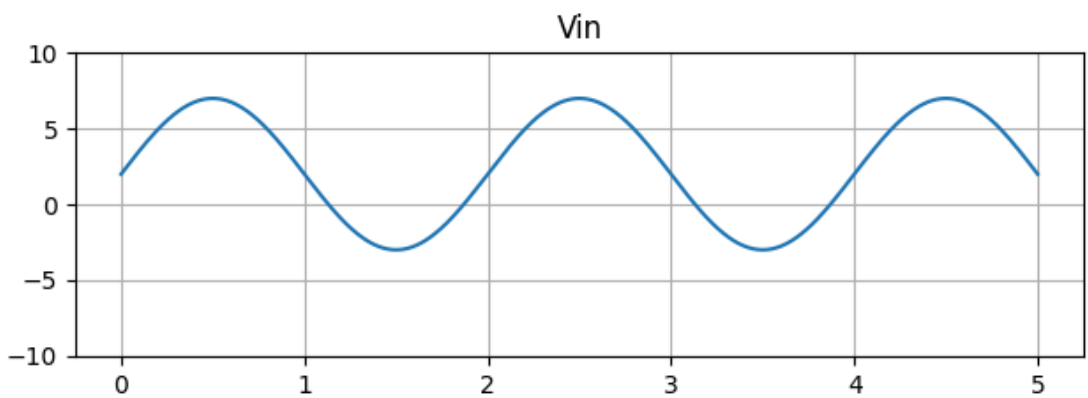
Since, V_+ is connected to ground, we have,

$$V_{out} = +10V \text{ if } V_{in} < 0V$$

$$V_{out} = -10V \text{ if } V_{in} > 0V$$



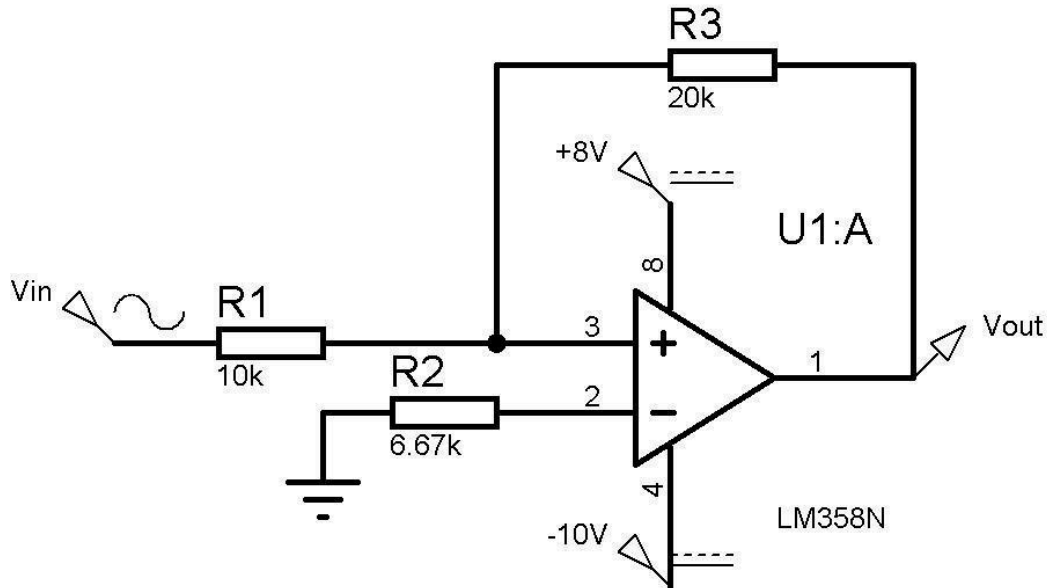
Output for input (a)



Output for input (b)

Question 4 - Schmitt Trigger

For the non-inverting schmitt trigger circuit below, V_{in} vs time plot is given. Draw the V_{out} vs time plot for the given input.



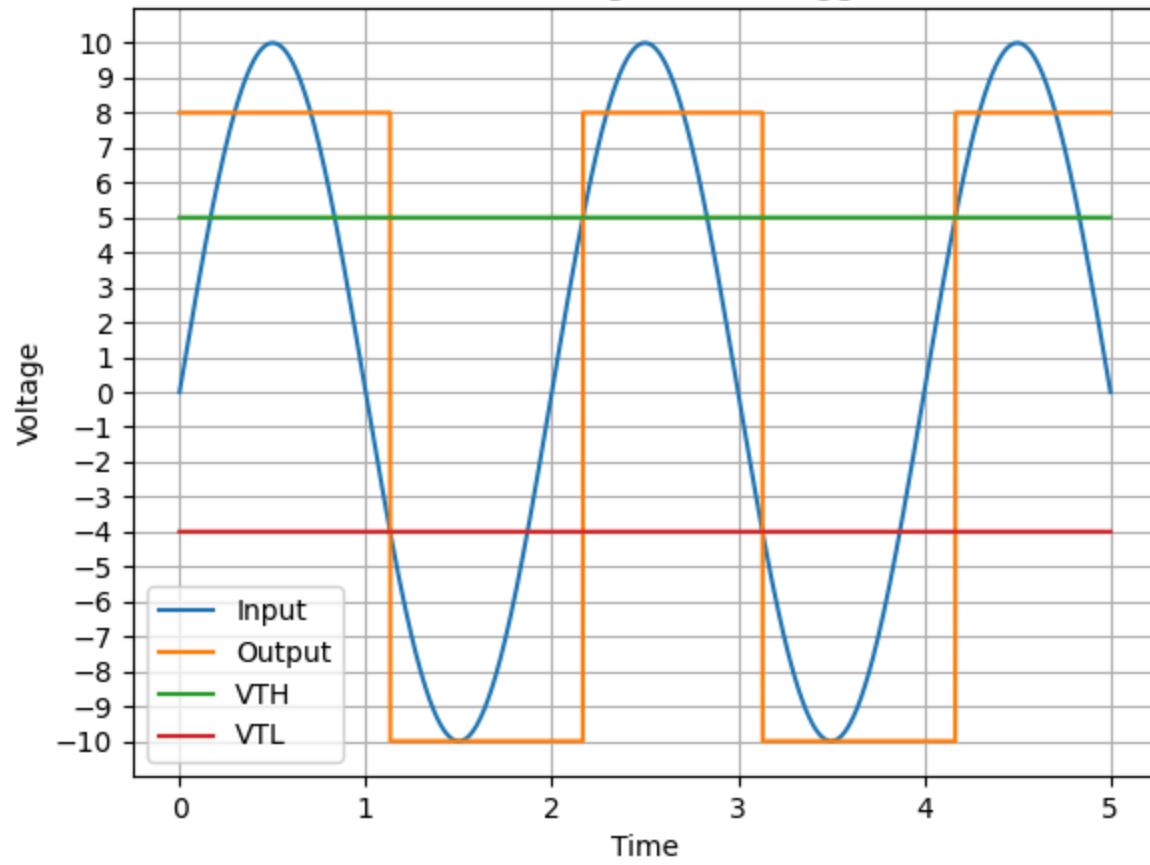
Solution:

For the non-inverting Schmitt trigger above, the threshold voltages are given as:

$$\text{Upper threshold, } V_{TH} = -\frac{R_1}{R_3}V_L = -\frac{10}{20} \times -10 = 5V$$

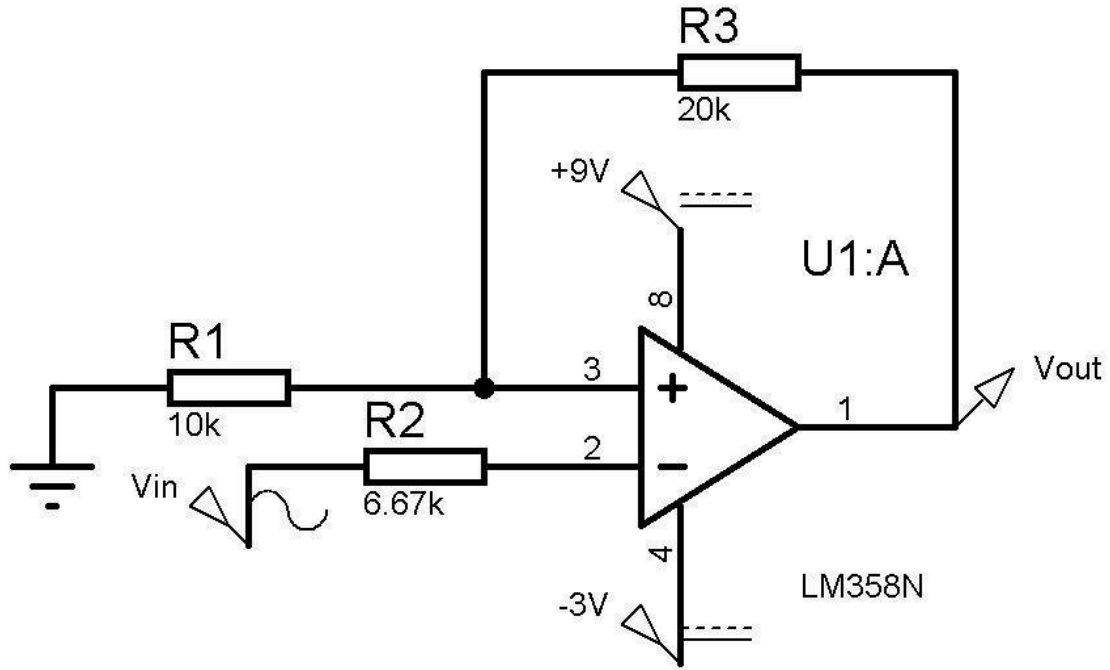
$$\text{Lower threshold, } V_{TH} = -\frac{R_1}{R_3}V_H = -\frac{10}{20} \times 8 = -4V$$

Non Inverting Schmitt Trigger



Question 5 - Schmitt Trigger

For the inverting schmitt trigger circuit below, V_{in} vs time plot is given. Draw the V_{out} vs time plot for the given input.



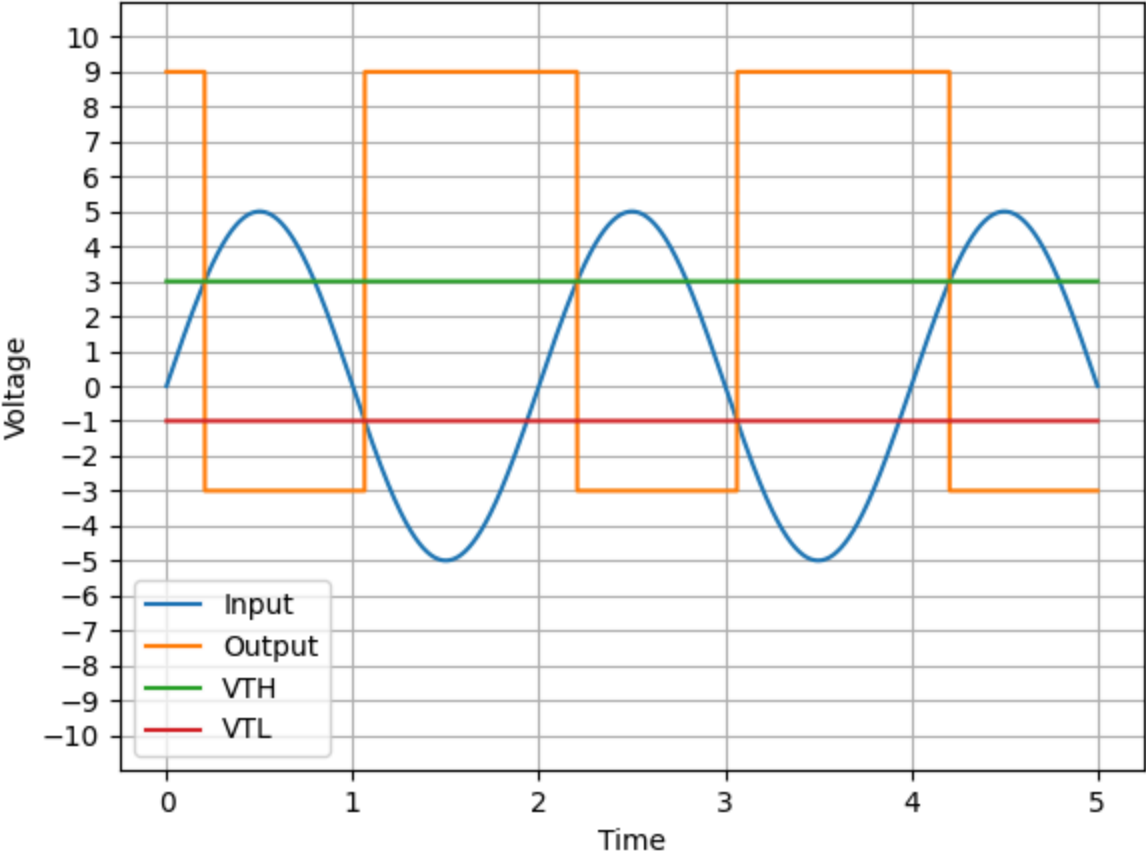
Solution:

For the inverting Schmitt trigger above, the threshold voltages are given as:

$$\text{Upper threshold, } V_{TH} = \frac{R_1}{R_1 + R_3} V_H = \frac{10}{30} \times 9 = 3V$$

$$\text{Lower threshold, } V_{TL} = \frac{R_1}{R_1 + R_3} V_L = \frac{10}{30} \times -3 = -1V$$

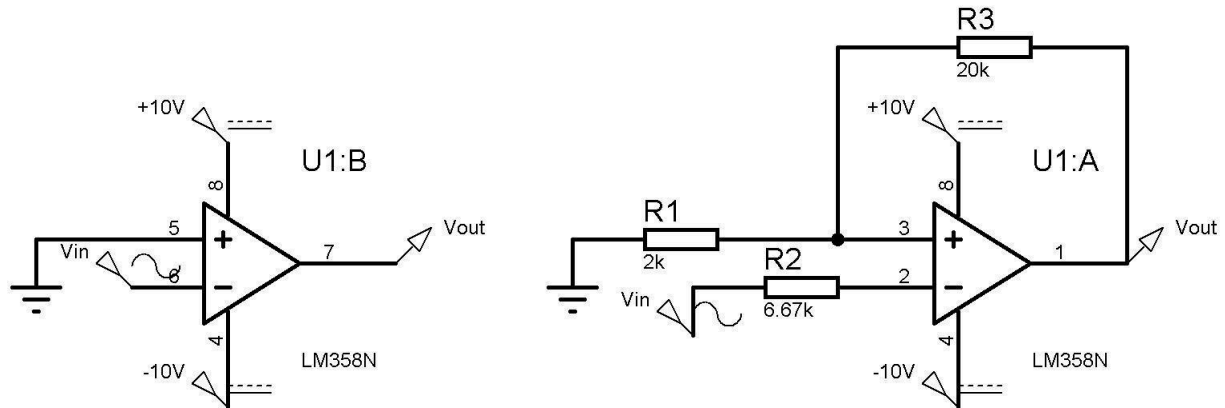
Inverting Schmitt Trigger



Question 6 - Comparator vs Schmitt Trigger

A light detector circuit has a sensor unit that generates a voltage proportional to the light intensity. You have been tasked with designing a circuit that will output high when the light level is low, and when the light intensity exceeds a certain threshold, the output will go low (turning off any artificial light). Two possible candidate circuits are 1. **Inverting Comparator** 2.

Inverting Schmitt Trigger as given below. The signal from the light sensor is corrupted by interference from the AC power line as shown in the graph below.



Solution:

Part (a)

For the OP-AMP comparator, we know that

$$V_{out} = V_H \text{ if } V_+ > V_-$$

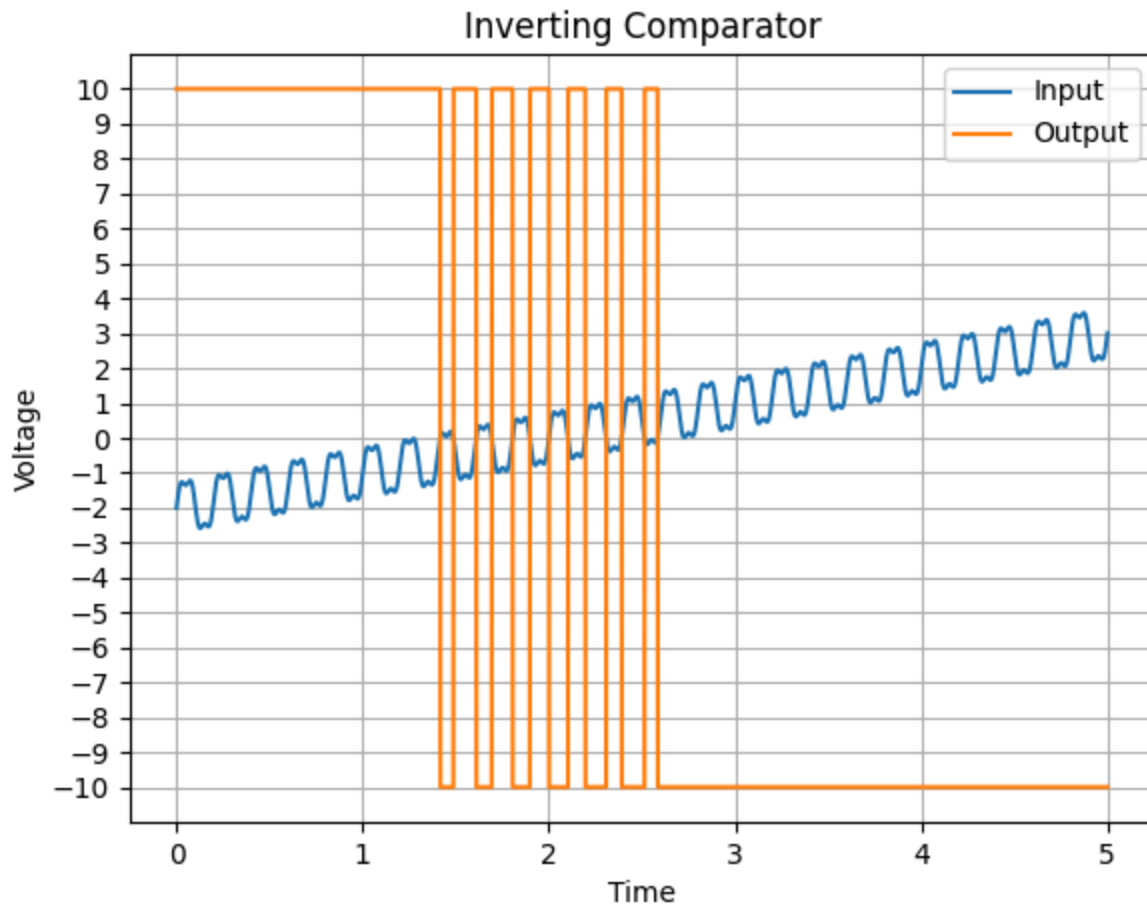
$$V_{out} = V_L \text{ if } V_+ < V_-$$

Since, V_+ is connected to ground, we have,

$$V_{out} = +10V \text{ if } V_{in} < 0V$$

$$V_{out} = -10V \text{ if } V_{in} > 0V$$

Thus for the first circuit, the output is given as (output switches whenever input crosses the x axis):



Part (b)

For the inverting Schmitt trigger, the threshold voltages are given as:

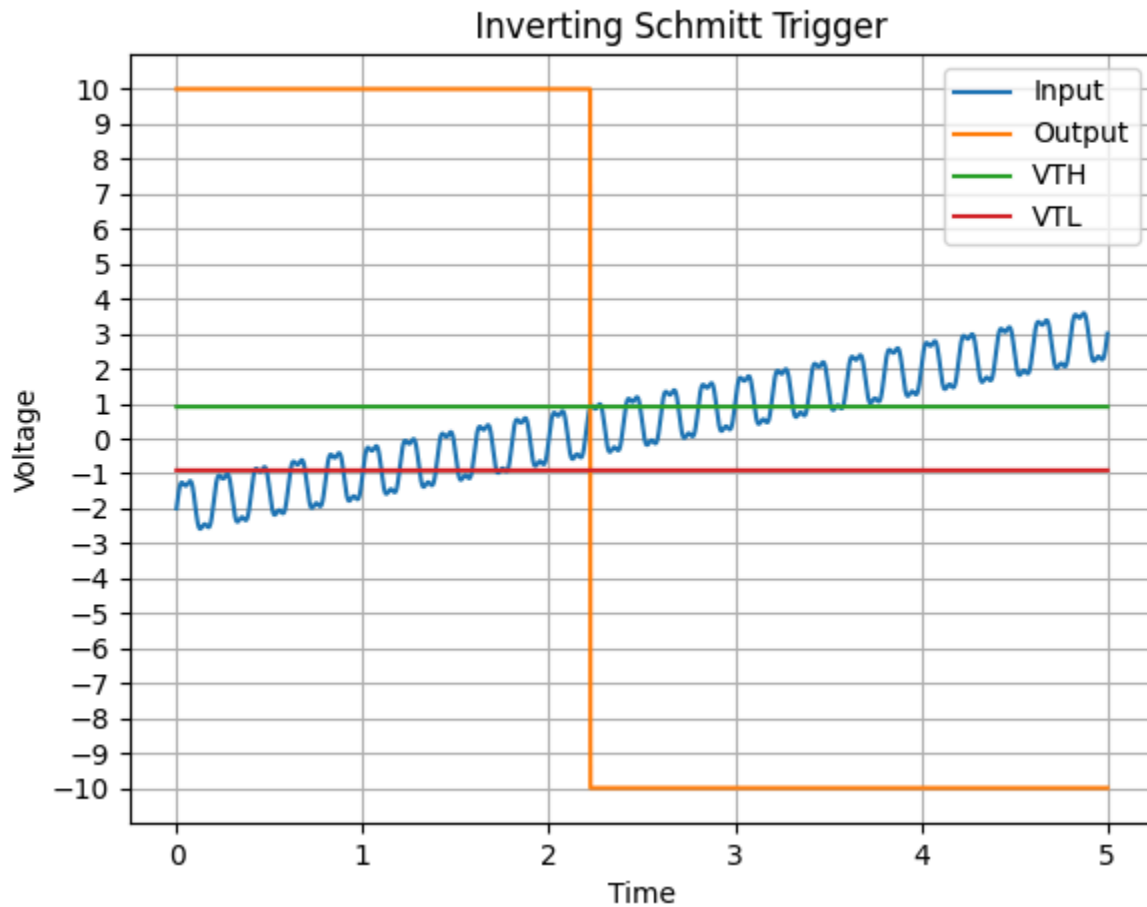
$$\text{Upper threshold, } V_{TH} = \frac{R_1}{R_1 + R_3} V_H = \frac{2}{22} \times 10 = 0.91\text{V}$$

$$\text{Lower threshold, } V_{TL} = \frac{R_1}{R_1 + R_3} V_L = \frac{2}{22} \times -10 = -0.91\text{V}$$

$$\text{Hysteresis width} = V_{TH} - V_{TL} = 1.82\text{V}$$

$$\text{Maximum allowable noise voltage} = \text{Hysteresis width} / 2 = 0.91\text{V}$$

When input voltage crosses the upper threshold for the first time, the output voltage goes low, and the lower threshold is activated. Unless the input voltage goes below the lower threshold level, the circuit will not switch again.



Part (c)

Whenever input crosses the threshold, the output of the first circuit will switch, resulting in oscillation on the output of the first circuit due to interference. However, the output of the second circuit only switches once due to the hysteresis of the Schmitt trigger. As such, the second circuit is more preferable.